Gwynedd Mercy University-School of Business & Education
(*Must be used for each lesson observed by University Supervisor*)
Lesson Plan Framework

Subject Area: Essential Skills and Strategies (ESS) **Grade Level: 9-12**

Student Name: Grace Dittman

Domain I: Planning and Preparation	
PA Standard(s): • PA SEL Competency — Self-Management: Demonstrate perseverance in the face of challenges and use effective coping strategies to manage stress and reach goals.	
Essential Question(s): Students will consider and reflect on throughout the lesson: • What does it mean to persevere when something gets hard? • What coping strategies can help us keep going instead of giving up?	
Objectives/Performance Expectations What will students know and be able to do as a result of this lesson? • Students will participate in a mindfulness video as a calming strategy. • Students will collaborate to solve a hands-on challenge (lifting a cup without touching it) as an introduction to perseverance. • Students will read about perseverance and identify a time they quit something before finishing. • Students will brainstorm personal strategies for persevering when things get difficult. • Students will identify why using coping strategies is important when faced with challenges.	
Assessment Evidence/Level of Learning Students will show what they know by evidence of/list names of formative or summative checks, quizzes, tests which indicate evidence of learning: • Participation in the mindfulness video • Participation and collaboration during the cup-	**Differentiated Instruction**: Modifications in instruction and assessment for students with learning differences, specifically those with 504's and IEP's. Extensions/Enrichment in instruction and assessment for students who are above grade level and/or gifted.

lifting challenge • Completed perseverance worksheet (strategy definitions, personal example, brainstormed 5th strategy) • Participation in the closing discussion	• Visual schedule posted for predictability • Cup-lifting challenge gives a hands-on, concrete experience of perseverance rather than only discussing it abstractly • Worksheet includes guided prompts to scaffold personal reflection • Option to share a personal example aloud or keep it private/written only • Visual summary slide reinforces key vocabulary and strategies at the end of the lesson

Domain II: Classroom Environment:

Describe Classroom/Behavior Management Plan & Routines

• Visual schedule displayed showing today's activities

• Calm, quiet environment maintained during the mindfulness video

• Collaborative, low-pressure framing for the cup-lifting challenge — multiple attempts are expected and are part of the point

• Positive reinforcement for perseverance shown during the activity itself

Domain III: Instruction

Activate Prior Knowledge/Motivation:

• (0-5 min) Students enter and complete their daily check-in.
• (5-15 min) Warm-up activity of choice.
• (15-20 min) Mindfulness video.

Preparing students for the lesson: How will you activate prior knowledge, build background, or review previous lessons as well as motivate students for the lesson?

Materials Needed:

• Visual schedule
• Daily check-in sheet or digital tool
• Warm-up activity choices
• Mindfulness video
• Cup, string, and rubber band for the perseverance challenge (one set per small group)

• Perseverance worksheet (printed copies)
• Closing summary slide

Vocabulary (New or Review):
• Perseverance — to keep going on a task even when it becomes difficult, without giving up
• Coping strategy — a tool used to manage a difficult feeling or situation
• Motivation — the reason behind why we want to do something

Sequence of the Lesson:
• (20-35 min) Group activity: using only string tied to rubber bands (no hands touching the cup directly), small groups work together to lift a cup off the table and move it, introduced as a hands-on first experience of perseverance — it will likely take several tries, and that's the point.
• (35-45 min) Transition discussion: connect the challenge to perseverance — ask students what made the activity hard, whether they wanted to give up, and what helped them keep trying.
• (45-75 min) Perseverance worksheet: students read 'What is Perseverance?', reflect on a time they quit something before finishing, and brainstorm strategies for persevering (including writing their own 5th strategy).
• (75-85 min) Closing summary slide: review that things will get hard sometimes, and that having coping strategies ready before that happens helps us respond instead of giving up. Tie together the mindfulness video, the cup challenge, and the worksheet strategies as three examples of tools practiced today.

What learning activities/strategies will you use to engage the students in the learning? What will students do to use and apply new concepts or skills (independent practice if relevant)? How will you monitor and guide their performance? Include relevant vocabulary. Use bullets to sequence your lesson.

Closure: What will you do to bring closure to the lesson? How will you summarize this lesson and preview the lesson that will follow?
• (85-90 min) Briefly recap the day's three activities and how each connects to perseverance and coping strategies.
• Collect the perseverance worksheet.

Reflection Guidelines

The student will write lesson plans with an eye to the Danielson Framework and the Four Domains of Professional Practice. Use this as a resource when writing lesson plans.

Domain I Planning and Preparation

1. How do you know you were knowledgeable of your content?
2. What is the evidence that your objective was clear in the lesson plan?
3. How does the lesson address individual student learning needs?
4. What variety of strategies and methodologies did you consider when planning?
5. What is the evidence that lesson components were logically sequenced?
6. How did your lesson plan include checks for student understanding?
7. What PA Standards did this lesson address?

Domain II Classroom Environment

1. How did students know the behavioral and academic expectations for the lesson?
2. What effective routines and procedures did you implement for lesson efficiency?
3. How did you insure the classroom was physically accessible for all learners?
4. What evidence indicates that respect was shown between and among students and teacher?
5. What evidence indicates that students placed a high value on quality

participation, process, and product?
6. How do you assess if the lesson was attainable for all students but also had appropriate rigor?

Domain III Instructional Delivery

1. How did you align your lesson to PA Standards?
2. How did you insure a clearly stated objective, understood by learners?
3. How did you provide clear explanations as to how to proceed through the lesson?
4. What questioning and discussion techniques insured all-learner participation?
5. What strategies did you employ to engage all students?
6. Describe how you made the content meaningful due to sequencing and pacing.
7. Discuss how you checked for understanding, provided feedback, retaught.
8. What is the evidence that you were you flexible and responsive to the needs of the learners?
9. Describe how you made meaning of the lesson with some form of closure activity.

Overall Assessment

Briefly state any changes you will make the next time you teach this lesson or activity, to improve any of the Domains of Professional Practice.